TOPIC 2 · 10 MIN · GMAIL

Lab 4: Skills: Teach Spark to Write Like Northstar

> Write your standards down once, and every reply after that comes out your way.

Your goal

Create a reusable skill, call it by name and test its refusal rule (LO2).

The story so far

You keep retyping the same instructions: short, friendly, no prices. That is a skill waiting to be written, and every later lab uses it.

You will deliver

- ☐ northstar-writer skill on your Skills page
- ☐ One test reply in Gmail Drafts

Before you start

A personal Google Account on Google AI Pro or Ultra, age 18+, Keep Activity and Personal Intelligence on. A laptop with Chrome. Copy every prompt from labs/prompts.html, or from the course prompts page: https://tertiarycourses.github.io/TGS-2026064173-AI-Agents-with-Gemini-Spark/labs/prompts.html

Your mock data

File in data/	What it is
northstar-content-inventory.csv	Approved and prohibited claims. Spark may only use these.
northstar-writer-skill.txt	Paste this into Create manually on the Skills page.

Steps

Step 1. Create the skill (4 min)

Where: Gemini → Customize → Skills → Create → Create manually

Open northstar-writer-skill.txt. Paste the name, description and instructions into the three fields and save.

Expect: northstar-writer appears on your Skills page.

Step 2. Test it, and make it refuse (6 min)

Where: Gemini → Task

Attach the inventory. Type @ and pick the skill, then paste the prompt.

PROMPT · COPY FROM THE LAB PROMPTS PAGE

```
@northstar-writer Save a Gmail draft replying to the [NORTHSTAR-LAB] email from Raj
Motors. He asks how much a five-page site costs and how soon you can start.
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Expect: It stops and asks you about the price and date, or leaves them out. It does not invent them.
You decide: If it drifts, fix the instructions and not the draft.

Checkpoint

The skill writes in your voice, refuses a price, and saves a draft without sending.

If you finish early, or after class

• Finish any good task, then type: turn this into a skill.

If Spark does not behave as described

Menus move and results vary, so this lab states what to expect and not exact wording. Check the source in Google Help, tell your trainer, and record what you actually saw. No Pro or Ultra account in class? Pair with a neighbour and complete the Docs, Sheets and Sites templates by hand.

All company data in this lab (Northstar Studio, people, enquiries, reviews, numbers) is fictional and generated for training.